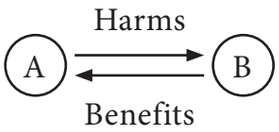
is one of the most complex microbial interactions. The line between parasitism and predation is difficult to define. The parasites feed on the cells, tissues or fluids of another organisms the host, which is harmed in this process.



The parasites depends on the host and lives in intimate physical and metabolic contact with the host. All types of plants and animals are susceptible to attack by microbial parasites.

10.6 Rhizosphere

In 1904, L.Hiltner for the first time coined the term "rhizosphere" to denote the area of intense microbiological activity that extends several millimeters from the root system of the growing plants.

The region which is adjacent to the root system is called rhizophere. The microbial population on and around root system is considerably higher than the root free soil or non rhizophere soil. This may be due the availability of nutrients from plants root in the form of root nodules, secretion, lysates, mucigel and sloughed off cells (Figure 10.5).

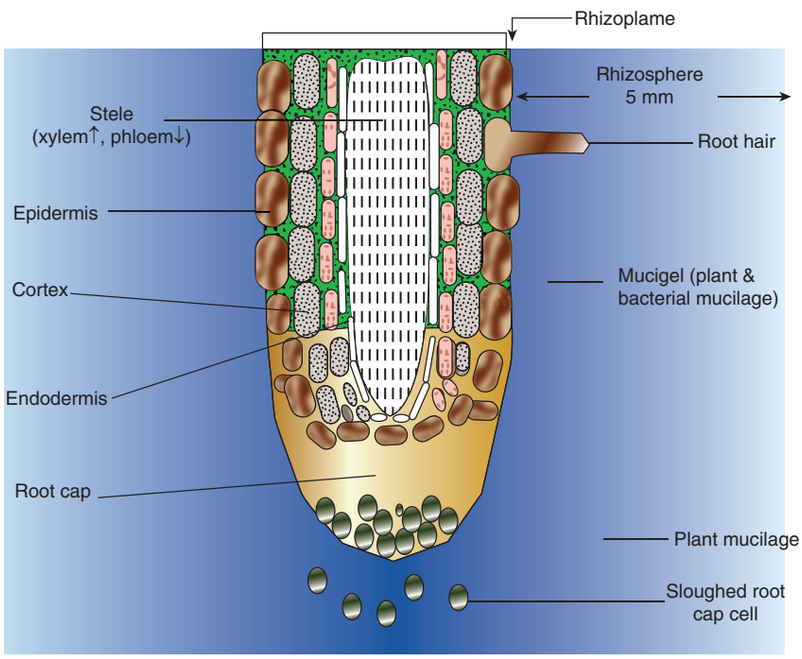


Figure 10.5: Root hair and Rhizosphere

The rhizospere region can be divided into two zones.

- Exorhizosphere
- Endorhizophere

However the root surface is termed as "rhizoplane".

Rhizophere Effect

The rhizophere is a zone of increased microbial community as well as microbial activities influenced by the root itself.

Greater rhizosphere effect is seen with bacteria (R: S values ranging from

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